

25 self-questions + story template

FREE TEMPLATE

Answer these honestly, in bullets. Then pick 8 and write them up.

1. What's something you did that nobody asked you to do?
2. When did you lead something, formally or not?
3. When did you fail at something that mattered to you?
4. What's the hardest feedback you've ever received?
5. When did you disagree with someone and how did it end?
6. What's a job or responsibility you had that most students your age didn't?
7. When did you have to learn something fast?
8. When did a team you were on fall apart, and what did you do?
9. What have you built, started, or organized?
10. When did you change someone's mind?
11. What's the most stressful week you've had, and how did you get through it?
12. When did you make a decision without enough information?
13. What's a mistake you made that affected other people?
14. When did you go beyond what was required?
15. What does your family expect of you, and how has that shaped you?
16. What's something you're known for among friends?
17. When did you help someone who was struggling?
18. What's a goal you set and hit? One you set and missed?
19. When did you have to work with someone you didn't like?
20. What's the most interesting problem you've ever worked on?
21. When did you take a risk?
22. What would people be surprised to learn about you?
23. What made you interested in this field in the first place?
24. When did you notice something others missed?
25. What are you proudest of that isn't on your resume?

The story template

PART	WHAT TO WRITE
Situation	Where were you, what was at stake, and why did it matter? Two sentences.
What you did	The specific actions you took. Use "I," not "we." This is most of the story.
What changed	The result, with a number if you have one. What was different because you acted?
What you learned	One sentence you'd actually say to a friend, and how you've used it since.